

MIRAGE: *Every Light Hides a Shadow.*

Themes: • Comic • Twist • Light

1. Overall Gameplay Idea

MIRAGE is a story-driven adventure game combining exploration, combat, puzzles and mystery. The player takes the role of a samurai who follows the orders of a mysterious monk. Each mission sends the samurai after a supposedly dangerous person. However, strange events, unexplained occurrences and contradictions in the monk's stories gradually make the player question what they are being told. The game progresses through three main missions, followed by a story reveal, an escape sequence and a final confrontation. A Hope Meter represents the player's inner light and changes based on their actions throughout the game.

2. Story & Plot

The game begins in silence. A young samurai kneels before his master — an old monk who speaks softly and commands unquestioning loyalty. He tells the samurai that certain people threaten the balance of the world and must be eliminated. The samurai obeys. But something doesn't add up. Whenever a target falls, a strange light escapes their body. The monk watches it disappear into his hands, yet never explains what it is.

As the missions continue, the samurai begins noticing things that do not fit the stories he has been told. People react strangely to the monk's name. The supposed enemies do not always seem as dangerous as described. Small details scattered throughout the world begin to contradict the monk's version of events. The player must continue carrying out the monk's orders while gradually piecing together the mystery.

After the third mission, the truth finally emerges. The monk is not who he claims to be. The samurai discovers that the people he was ordered to eliminate were connected to the protection of the human world. The monk has been using the samurai to obtain their light for his own purpose.

Realising what he has done, the samurai escapes and finds refuge in an old Buddhist Vihara. There, a true monk reveals the hidden balance between light and darkness and grants the samurai sacred light. The game culminates in a final confrontation where the samurai faces the master he once trusted.

3. Game Flow & Gameplay

- **Mission 1 — The Order** The monk gives the samurai his first target. The player explores a small area, interacts with people and encounters simple obstacles before reaching the target. After the fight, the mysterious light is introduced for the first time.
- **Mission 2 — The Doubt** The monk gives another order, but this time the player encounters details that do not match his story. Exploration and simple puzzles lead the player towards the target. The consequences of the previous mission begin to affect the samurai's Hope Meter.
- **Mission 3 — The Truth.** The final order leads the samurai deeper into the mystery. Clues found throughout the level begin connecting the unexplained

events from the previous missions. After the third confrontation, the monk's true identity and intentions are revealed.

- **Escape & Vihara** The samurai escapes from his former master and reaches an old Buddhist Vihara. A true monk explains the balance between light and darkness and grants the samurai sacred light.
- **Final Battle** The samurai returns to confront the creature that manipulated him. The final battle brings the story to its conclusion.

4. Gameplay Mechanics

- **Exploration:** Players explore compact environments and interact with people to discover information and clues.
- **Hope Meter:** The player's inner light is represented by a Hope Meter. Actions and choices throughout the game can affect it.
- **Narration:** The monk communicates directly with the player through on-screen dialogue, guiding the player while creating doubt about his true intentions.
- **Clues:** Environmental details and conversations gradually reveal information that contradicts the monk's version of events.

5. Justification of Themes

- **Light :** Light represents life, hope and protection. It is also represented through the player's Hope Meter, making it an important part of the gameplay.
- **Twist :** The game gradually changes the player's understanding of who is good and who is evil, leading to the revelation about the monk.
- **Comic :** The comic theme is reflected through the game's presentation and storytelling, giving important moments a comic-like feel.

6. Team Members

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